PRACTICAL ROLE PLAYBOOK

BrandGuard User Guide

A clear, step-by-step guide for Creators, Managers, Reviewers, and Admins.

Open the live BrandGuard workspace

One workflow, four clear responsibilities

BrandGuard helps a team check brand and compliance guidance, resolve findings, route content for human review, and keep a record of decisions. AI suggestions do not edit or publish content on their own.

CREATOR Create and check content, resolve findings, then submit or resubmit it.	**MANAGER** Run the approval queue, assign reviewers, decide standard-risk work, and monitor guideline health.
REVIEWER Review assigned items and provide compliance sign-off for high-risk content.	**ADMIN** Manage users, sources, settings, audit records, and feedback tools.

Important rule People make the decisions. A Creator cannot approve their own work, an Admin cannot approve submissions, and high-risk approval requires an assigned Reviewer.

Start here

Sign in, understand the stages, and know who owns the next action.

Signing in

+ For the public demo, use the Demo accounts panel on the login page. Click the button for the role you want to explore; the throwaway credentials are shown there.
+ For a private workspace, use the account created by your Admin. Demo mode should be off for private work.
+ The first sign-in tips are role-specific. Use Tips in the navigation bar to open them again.
+ The navigation bar also has the dark-mode toggle, notification bell, and signed-in account controls.

The main workflow

1	**Create**	Creator enters a title, intent, and text or supported file.	Intent helps reviewers understand what the content is meant to achieve.
2	**Check**	Run the review. BrandGuard returns findings with severity, evidence, and suggested fixes when available.	Find issues before content enters the approval queue.
3	**Resolve**	Creator accepts, edits, or disputes each finding. Give a reason when disputing.	Human choices are recorded and improve future suggestions.
4	**Submit**	After checking the current revision, the Creator requests review.	Reviewers see the latest checked version.
5	**Assign**	Manager assigns a Reviewer when needed and sets or adjusts the due date.	Clear ownership and deadlines help work move on time.
6	**Decide**	Manager decides standard-risk work; assigned Reviewer signs off high-risk work.	Approval authority matches the content risk.
7	**Revise**	If changes are requested or work is rejected, Creator revises, checks again, and resubmits.	Every submitted revision can be checked and reviewed.

Status words

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS
Draft	Work is still being prepared.	Not ready for approval.
Checked	A review check has been run on this revision.	A Creator can request review for this checked version.
In review	The item is in the Manager/Reviewer queue.	Assignments, due dates, and decisions are available.
Changes requested	Reviewer/Manager asked the Creator to revise.	Create a new version, recheck, and resubmit.
Approved / Rejected	A human reviewer recorded the final workflow decision.	The decision and note remain in the history.

CREATOR MY WORK / NEW SUBMISSION / REVIEW

Creator: prepare and submit content

Your workspace is My Work. You can create and revise your own submissions, resolve findings, and follow their review status.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS
New Submission	Enter a clear title and intended message, then add text or upload a file.	A stated intent gives suggestions and reviewers useful context.
Run Check	Checks the current revision against guidelines, facts, terms, and available media rules.	Find problems before review and reduce avoidable revision cycles.
Findings	Open a finding to see its issue, severity, evidence, and suggested rewrite when available.	Evidence helps you decide whether a fix is appropriate.
Accept / Edit	Accept a suggestion or enter your own revision. The app creates a new version.	Your original content and the human edit stay traceable.
Dispute	Challenge a finding and explain why it does not apply.	Disputes feed guideline health and the rewrite feedback model.
Request Review	Submit only after the latest revision has been checked.	The Manager receives a clear, current version to review.
Revise / Resubmit	When changes are requested or an item is rejected, edit it, run Check again, then resubmit.	Keeps the approval trail connected to the text actually reviewed.

Useful Creator tools

+ Search by title or intent and filter by status. Save a view to quickly return to the same filters; views are saved in this browser for your account.
+ The notification bell shows workflow decisions and opens the related submission.
+ Feedback metrics summarize how suggestions are accepted, edited, or disputed.
+ Uploads: TXT, DOCX, PDF, PNG, JPEG, and sanitized SVG; maximum 5 MB. Raster images are limited to 12 megapixels and checks to 5,000 words.

Creator checklist Before requesting review, check the latest revision, resolve or explain open findings, and make sure the intent still describes the content.

MANAGER TEAM COMMAND CENTER / GUIDELINE HEALTH / INSIGHTS

Manager: route and decide work

Your workspace is the Team Command Center. Use the queue to assign ownership, make permitted decisions, and spot recurring issues.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS
Approval queue	Search, filter by status, and open submissions awaiting review. Save useful search/status combinations as views.	Keeps active work easy to find.
SLA and age	See how long items have waited against the four-hour queue target.	Highlights work that needs attention.
Reviewer assignment	Assign an active Reviewer. New assignments receive a default 24-hour due date; Managers can change or clear it.	Makes accountability and timing visible.
Overdue indicators	Manager and assigned Reviewer see whether an open assignment is overdue.	Surfaces late work before it is missed.
Workflow decisions	Approve standard-risk work, request changes, or reject with a note.	Gives the Creator a clear next step and records the decision.
High-risk boundary	High-risk approval requires an assigned Reviewer to sign off.	Keeps elevated-risk decisions with the required reviewer.
Guideline Health	Review clause dispute friction and recurring themes. Use Recompute now for a fresh calculation; managers may edit clauses.	Shows where guidance is confusing or repeatedly disputed.
Reports and insights	View trends and feedback statistics. Export workflow approval history as CSV or PDF.	Supports audit, oversight, and sharing results.

Manager checklist Confirm the current version and risk level, assign a Reviewer when required, set a realistic due date, and include a useful note with changes requested or rejection.

REVIEWER COMPLIANCE DESK / ASSIGNED ITEMS

Reviewer: assess assigned content

Your workspace is the Compliance Desk. It focuses on items assigned to you and escalated findings that need compliance attention.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS
Assigned queue	Open submissions assigned to you and see their due date and overdue state.	Makes your active responsibilities clear.
Evidence review	Inspect findings, cited source quotes, severity, and the content under review.	Supports decisions based on approved evidence rather than guesswork.
PDF highlights	For located PDF findings, select a finding to see its highlighted page location.	Reduces time spent finding the relevant passage in a document.
Image findings	When image review is enabled, inspect OCR text and visual findings on the image.	Can reveal text or visual issues that plain text review would miss.
Compliance notes	Add a note explaining your decision or what needs attention.	Gives the Creator and Manager an actionable record.
High-risk sign-off	Approve or reject high-risk assigned work according to the review flow.	Provides the required human review for elevated risk.

How to review an assignment

+ Open the assigned submission and confirm the title, intent, status, and version.
+ Read the content alongside each finding and inspect its cited evidence.
+ For a high-risk item, make the reviewer decision and record a concise compliance note.
+ If you are not the assigned Reviewer, ask the Manager to assign the item; access is intentionally limited.

Reviewer boundary Reviewers work only on assigned submissions. Admins do not approve submissions, and no Creator may approve their own submission.

ADMIN ADMIN CONSOLE / USERS / SOURCES / AUDIT

Admin: operate the workspace

Your workspace is the Admin Console. Admin controls maintain people, approved sources, settings, and oversight records.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS
Users and roles	Create accounts, set roles, activate/deactivate users, and reset passwords.	Gives each person the right workspace and access.
Approved Sources	Manage the source records used to support guidance and findings.	Keeps checks grounded in the current approved material.
Runtime settings	View or change available application settings.	Lets administrators operate the environment intentionally.
System status	Inspect restricted operational details such as database/provider status.	Helps identify configuration or service issues.
Audit log	Review recorded administrative and workflow activity; export the audit log as CSV.	Supports accountability and investigation.
Feedback tools	Review feedback statistics and reset the learned preference model when appropriate.	Makes the effect of accumulated feedback visible.
Reports and insights	View organization insights and export approval history as CSV or PDF.	Supports oversight and reporting.

Admin boundary Admins can manage the workspace but cannot approve submissions. Managers and assigned Reviewers make content decisions.

Demo mode Keep DEMO_MODE=true only for a public throwaway demo. It exposes shared demo accounts and synchronizes their known throwaway passwords at startup. Turn it off for private workspaces.

Features everyone should know

Use these tools across role dashboards to make review work clearer and more repeatable.

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS
Notifications	The navbar bell shows unread assignment and workflow-decision notifications. Open an item or mark it read.	Keeps the right person informed inside the app. Notifications do not send email.
Saved views	Save a search and status filter on Creator My Work or the Manager queue.	Reduces repeated setup. Views stay in the current browser and do not sync devices.
Approval reports	Managers and Admins download workflow decision history as CSV or PDF.	Provides an exportable record of approvals, changes requested, and rejections.
Password change	Signed-in users can change their password after entering the current one. Admins can reset accounts.	Supports account hygiene. Shared demo passwords stay fixed while demo mode is on.
Dark mode	Toggle Dark/Light in the navbar. The choice is saved in the browser.	Makes the workspace comfortable in different lighting.
Onboarding tips	First sign-in shows tips for the current role. Choose Tips in the navbar to reopen them.	Helps new users find the right workflow without changing permissions.
Audit history	Workflow decisions and administrative changes are recorded and visible to permitted roles.	Preserves accountability and helps explain what happened.

The three improvements

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS
A. Guideline Health	Nightly and on-demand dispute-friction calculations group repeated issues by clause. Managers/Admins can recompute now.	Highlights unclear rules so teams can improve the source guidance.
B. Image and PDF Review	PDF findings can carry page coordinates/highlights. Enabled image review uses Tesseract OCR and visual checks.	Catches text and layout issues while keeping a link to where they appear.
C. Feedback Loop	Accept/edit/dispute decisions train a persisted preference model; repeated clause/span disputes are suppressed after three distinct findings.	Ranks useful rewrites over time and reduces repeated noise.

Good habits and quick fixes

Use the controls safely and know where to look when something does not work.

Safeguards and practical limits

+ AI proposes suggestions; a human chooses whether to accept, edit, dispute, request changes, reject, or approve. Nothing is automatically published.

+ Only supported uploads up to 5 MB are accepted. Raster images are limited to 12 megapixels; one text check is limited to 5,000 words.

+ Image/OCR checks require IMAGE_REVIEW_ENABLED=true and the Tesseract runtime. PDF extraction and page highlights are separate from image OCR.

+ OCR can misread stylized text. Color, logo, clear-space, and contrast checks depend on approved asset metadata and detectable regions. Always inspect the original.

+ If Anthropic is enabled, content segments, declared intent, and retrieved source excerpts are sent to that provider. Mock mode does not make external LLM calls.

+ Saved views and theme choices are browser-local. Notifications cover assignments and workflow decisions, not email or every finding comment.

Troubleshooting

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHY IT MATTERS
Demo sign-in says wrong password	Confirm DEMO_MODE=true and that the current app build is deployed. Demo accounts synchronize on startup in demo mode.	Reload the login page after deployment. If it continues, ask the Admin to check the deployed service and its startup logs.
Image upload has no OCR result	Check IMAGE_REVIEW_ENABLED=true, OCR_BACKEND=tesseract, and that the service uses the Docker runtime.	The Render Docker setup includes Tesseract. Restart/redeploy after changing environment variables.
You see 403 Forbidden	You may be opening another Creator's submission, an unassigned review, or a role-restricted page.	Use the correct account or ask a Manager to assign the Reviewer.
You cannot submit for review	The current revision may be unchecked or the submission may not be in a submit-ready state.	Run Check again after the latest edit, then request review.
A report or audit download fails	Make sure you are signed in with Manager/Admin access and retry from that dashboard.	Export access follows the role permissions.

Need help? Open Tips for role guidance, check the notification bell for assignments or decisions, and contact the workspace Admin for account or access problems.